

CONNECTING THE DOTS

Capex Boom, Frontier exploration, AI orchestration, Halma, BSTL and Banks plus key research

Navigating the Capex Boom. Peter Oppenheimer's [must read on Capex here](#), including why he expects more scope for alpha generation. We are hosting a call with him on Monday ([sign up](#)) along with some of the analysts from sectors which benefit from the investment (e.g., Hardware, Utilities, Cap Goods). **One of these sectors — Utilities — looks very different to history given this growth, so we are also doing a Back to Basics with Alberto Gandolfi** to understand his new framework within which we should view the sector (as well as covering some of the basics which haven't changed) – on Monday ([sign up](#)).

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Frontier exploration is back even with a lower oil price. Amidst Iran and US MoU headlines, oil has eased off to c\$80/bbl, and despite feedback in the past few weeks that clients were looking to buy the dip, energy equities have been weak. We would revisit oil services names as a play on oil capex picking up. **This week we saw more evidence of this return to exploration and particularly frontier exploration**, with the list of areas IOCs and NOCs are willing to go growing according to [feedback from the EAGE seismic industry conference](#) last week (via Viridien ex CGG) and [Equinor increasing capex by \\$1bn for 2027](#) and enhancing its focus on frontier exploration at its CMD. **We sat down with Michele Della Vigna and Anastasia Shalaeva to discuss these takeaways in a c10 min episode of On the Road, [listen here](#).** The biggest pushback to buying oil services is the aforementioned Brent weakness, and Michele makes the point that these projects make sense in an oil price world of \$60/bbl (vs. current c\$80 spot) so you need to be a lot more bearish on oil to de-rail this. **Buy TGS** in seismic.

As a reminder, this isn't just because of recent Middle East events, it's more sustainable. *The focus on oil capex from majors was starting to come back before the recent conflict as investors started to reward spending on exploration rather than just buybacks given [reserve life is down 60% over the last 10 years](#) and the source of that underinvestment (US Shale creating an overhang on the oil price) is finally maturing. Energy security only adds to this pressure.*

AI and orchestration. One snippet from an expert call hosted in the US by Matthew Martino: “autonomous software development creates a new operational requirement around validating, diagnosing, and responding to changes in production with far less human intervention than before. Management described a potential “dark factory” model in which coding agents ship code, SRE agents evaluate production behavior, diagnose

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issues, and feed that information back into the development loop, creating a tighter connection between software creation and software operation.”

Baskets vs. bottom up stories: Halma. Halma is a high quality name which has very high growth, but saw a c15% sell off last week post results as it was viewed as a play on one ‘theme’ where the market found Photonics guidance disappointing vs. elevated expectations. The name has historically been a compounder with a well proven growth algorithm, including M&A, where the pushback has typically been a lack of upside / valuation. Christian Hinderaker is Buy rated and now has 25%+ PT upside given the Photonics pull back, so we sat down with him on our **Going Against the Grain episode, listen here** as this is a name worth coming back to on weakness. We do discuss Photonics to address the obvious points (he thinks guidance is conservative and is ahead of it) but **listen from 10 minutes onwards to refresh views beyond Photonics** for the part where there is less focus but where growth trends are healthy and in defensive end markets.

BSTL conference feedback – positive for both **DSV** (positive on cyclical backdrop and structural AI benefits) and **IHG** (NUG momentum building, US RevPAR strong), which are both on the CL.

Bank themes for generalists. Post a week of strength across banks, we are revisiting our recent On the Road episode with feedback from our Financials Conference to refresh the key themes we should be focused on from macro and regulation to AI and more, listen here. Chris Hallam gives an **overview (1.54 to 7:29)** if you want the highlights.

GS Research from the week

We filter this week’s research through the merchandising lens to highlight actionable ideas and pull out some themes / key messages which we think are important - click into the reports for more!

AI, Data Centres and CAPEX

On the need to spend

Global Strategy Paper: The Post Modern Cycle – Navigating the Capex Boom - Peter Oppenheimer looks at this phase of capital intensive growth with drivers of returns more likely from EPS than valuation resulting in cross-sectional dispersion, increasing scope for alpha generation.

Multi-Industry Capex Tracker: Medium-term capex expectations continue to improve - Daniela Costa highlights Capex continues to improve with 2026E capex up 2pp since March largely by Tech (Data Centers) and Utilities. **Buy:** Schneider on CL, VAT for Semis and Prysmian and Nexans for Power Grids

Powering up Europe: Booming Datacenter pipeline and AI spending boom - the pivotal role of energy - Alberto Gandolfi estimates the data center pipeline is now nearly 500GW (1.5x current EU power demand) which is a 70% increase since his last update 6 months ago. **Alberto and our US Utilities team discuss the impact of rising power demand on the Renewables outlook in a recent podcast, listen here.**

US Strategy: The impact of the AI capex boom on S&P 500 return on equity - Ben Snider notes the AI capex boom has lifted semiconductor profitability but will be an increasing headwind to mega-cap tech ROE going forward.

Digital Infrastructure: AI Infrastructure from the Field: Takeaways from 2nd Annual Denver trip - Michael Ng notes hyperscaler AI infrastructure demand remains strong, with continued strengthening of data center pricing power.

Supply chain

Taiwan Technology: US marketing feedback: AI ASIC remains the preferred theme with focus on CPU and next supply chain bottlenecks

BE Semiconductor Industries (BESI.AS): Investor Day highlights expanding AI-driven packaging opportunity and HB adoption; Buy - Alex Duval highlights expanding AI-driven packaging opportunity and HB adoption.

Nexans (NEXS.PA): Electra visit and CEO/CFO takeaways, reiterate Buy - Daniela Costa came away more constructive on the stock, noting high renewables, T&D exposure and a potential increase in exposure to data centers, especially given home market (France) builds more.

IT impact

Americas Technology: Software: Expert Network Series: Dash0 on Observability in the Agentic Age - Expert call highlights “autonomous software development creates a new operational requirement around validating, diagnosing, and responding to changes in production with far less human intervention than before. Management described a potential “dark factory” model in which coding agents ship code, SRE agents evaluate production behavior, diagnose issues, and feed that information back into the development loop, creating a tighter connection between software creation and software operation.”

Americas Technology: IT Spending Survey: AI momentum continues to build against a more muted broader outlook - Gabriela Borges highlights 88% of CIOs (vs 93% prior) expect AI to account for <10% of IT budgets, reflecting an ongoing testing and refinement phase (weighted average of 5%). Over 3 years, 42% (vs 35% prior) anticipate GenAI to exceed 10% of their IT budgets, with a weighted average of 10%.

Accenture Plc (ACN): Tepid quarter and outlook reflects near-term macro headwinds - The stock was down significantly on results which James Schneider notes reflects AI concerns and outlook reflecting broader macro headwinds.

Jobs impact

GS SUSTAIN Insights: The Future of Work - Labor Shortages, Automation & AI - Evan Tylanda's feedback from the expert call with Randstad includes manufacturing labour shortages in Europe and the US have resulted in a 400% increase in electrical trade enrolments, however it can take 8 years to develop a worker.

Strait of Hormuz Re-Opening

Oil Analyst: Reducing Our Price Forecast on Deal to Reopen Hormuz - Dan Struyven reduces his price forecasts on a deal to reopen Hormuz to \$80 by 4Q26 (from \$90) and to \$75 (vs \$80) for '27.

Natural Gas Analyst: US-Iran Agreement Paves Way For European Storage Refill – Samantha Dart leaves her forecasts largely unchanged on the back of SoH normalization, higher ex Qatar supply and lower market target for European storage. She sees long-term oversupply with risk that a pick-up in coal and renewables adds pressure.

Oil Tracker: 70% of Pre-War Hormuz Flows Might Become the New 100% – Yulia Zhestkova Grigsby notes 70% of SoH flows might become the new 100% and her tracker shows the redirections number is high with some constraint in shipowners unclear on guidelines.

Big Oils: Oil price implied in EU Big Oils and sensitivities on a potential Hormuz re-opening

Europe Transportation: Airports: What to do in the sector & who would benefit most from geopolitical “Reopening”

China Transportation: Assessing a Hormuz reopening scenario; Prefer Tankers, Airlines and Shipbuilders

We have two replays on Strait of Hormuz reopening 1) on Iran Markets Post Hormuz Reopening hosted by Adam Crook including Jan Hatzius, listen [here](#) and **2)** discussing our updated energy outlook with our commodities team research and trading (GBM), listen [here](#).

Oil Capex

Equinor (EQNR.OL): CMD: \$1bn capex step-up to accelerate prod gr. and Buyback upgrade. Remains Sell on negative long-term TTF view, Sell

Energy: Oil Services: Key takeaways from call with Viridien post EAGE conference: “Frontier Exploration is back” – Michele Della Vigna highlights the Viridien CFO was bullish on the EAGE conference last week, noting “frontier exploration is back” with record EAGE attendance (proxy for interest in exploration) screening positive for TGS.

We have a new edition of our European On the Road with GS podcast including Michele discussing what we learned on oil capex and why frontier exploration is back, listen [here](#).

Rates

USA: June FOMC Recap: Hikes Look More Likely but Are Still Not Our Base Case – David Mericle notes a hawkish surprise and raises risk of interest rate hikes later this year but his base case is still unchanged for this year. If SoH trade resumes, he notes some of the views might be stale; Fed noted that 5 taskforces are to be created to rethink communications.

European Daily: BoE Recap—Content with Holding – James Moberly notes the MPC held rates at the recent meeting and continues to expect the BoE to remain on hold through the year and then lowering rates in 2027.

Moderating Near-Term Gold Price Upside on No Fed Cuts This Year – Lina Thomas highlights moderating near-term price upside on no Fed cuts this year, and cuts her forecast to \$4,900/toz by Dec (vs \$5,400 prior), remaining tactically cautious.

UK Home Builders: Post deep-dive feedback: Investors on Sidelines, Focus Shifts to Execution - Rebecca Parker highlights low interest with the sector treated as homogenous but affordability differences mean divergence should occur. Rebecca would avoid southern market exposure (Sell Berkeley) and Buy Persimmon and Barratt Redrow.

Aluminium (Norsk Hydro is on the CL)

China Base Metals: China aluminum sector - accelerating pace of supply additions; downgrade Chalco-H/A to Sell/Sell, maintain Hongqiao at Neutral - Trina Chen's recent discussions suggest acceleration in aluminum supply additions in both China and ex-China, prompted by strong industry profits

Base Metals Analyst: Aluminium: A Tale of Two Supply Shocks - Lavinia Forcellese sees Middle East outages as keeping the aluminum market tighter for longer, even if the strait re-opens. She nudges her Q3 2026/average 2027 LME aluminium price forecasts to \$3,300/\$2,950/t from \$3,200/\$2,750/t previously.

Capital Markets Activity

Three notes from Oliver Carruthers:

- **European Capital Markets:** Key themes shaping Capital Markets; downgrading AJ Bell and DWS to Sell, Aberdeen to Neutral - Oliver sees an improving market backdrop for private markets, highlighting Buy-rated CL CVC as a name with attractive risk-reward and flatexDEGIRO with continued growth and efficiency. However, he downgrades DWS and AJ Bell to Sell, as while both have done well, DWS is showing early moderation of core drivers and AJ Bell is likely to face more competition.
- **CVC Capital Partners (CVC.AS):** Secondaries deep-dive session key takeaways; Buy (on CL) - Emphasises structural tailwinds and differentiated offering.
- **Partners Group (PGHN.S):** FAQs on the Evergreen Business Part II; Neutral - Discusses the key questions surrounding the weak flows, drivers of performance and implications on consensus estimates, including the potential for lower performance fees in FY26 which he expects may impact dividend coverage and therefore cuts his estimates.

Global Markets Daily: US Credit Card and Auto Delinquency Rates: Less Bad Than They Look - Arun Monohar notes the share of credit card and auto loans that are 90 days or more past due on their payments has reached 13.1% and 5.6%, respectively, as of Q1 2026, back in line with the Global Financial Crisis peak. This is a widely followed indicator for evaluating the health of the US consumer.

Global Credit Trader: Credit Spread Dispersion: A Tale of Two Markets - Amanda Lynam highlights that beneath the surface there is divergence with IG dispersion unusually low, while HY dispersion is elevated.

Americas Brokers & Asset Managers: Solid May monthly metrics include robust engagement, cash, and NNA

Business Services, Transport, Leisure, Infra & Building Materials Conference

Business Services, Transport, Leisure, Infra & Building Materials Conference hosted

by Patrick Creuset and his team in London with 40+ companies. **See all takeaway notes [here](#)** some highlights:

- **Transport** and **Logistics** - Still expects a stronger 2Q for DSV (Buy, on CL), with the DBS integration on track and the ability to restart the buyback before reaching 2x leverage (Patrick expects it to restart from Q3). As well as DSV, K+N (Buy) is also well placed within freight and on AI-related productivity benefits.
- **Europe Leisure** Day 1 and 2 - IHG'S NUG momentum is building, US RevPAR is strong and World Cup tailwinds are on track.

Ratings Changes & Initiations

AJ Bell (AJBA.L) and DWS (DWSG.DE) Down to Sell - See details in Capital Markets Activity bucket above.

Public Power Corp. (DEHr.AT): Reinstate at Buy - Mafalfa Pombeiro reinstates PPC at Buy given the equity raise completion allowing investment ramp. Even assuming partial delivery relative to guidance gives 18% upside to her PT and her full execution scenario implies c30%+ upside to the share price (with more upside from rerating).

GEA Group (G1AG.DE): Initiate at Neutral - Daniela Costa believes GEA is high quality but valuation is fair.

Zegna (ZGN): Down to Neutral - Adrien Duverger downgrades Zegna following strong share performance. Illustrative SOTP analysis is new.

Reiterate Buy

Siemens Energy (ENR1n.DE): Restructuring to bring greater focus & higher margins?: Buy (on CL) - Ajay Patel notes Siemens Energy is considering spinning off Transformation & Industry segment. A disposal, if confirmed, would focus the portfolio and improve margins. The stock is on CL and Ajay expects consensus upgrades with MT guidance at FY.

Vonovia (VNAn.DE): Supportive underlying data points, rates correlation broken: reiterate Buy (on CL) - Jonathan Kownator highlights supportive operating trends and is c4% ahead of consensus on 2027 earnings driven by non-rental growth and deleveraging. The stock is currently down YTD but in his view this creates a good entry point. **See also:** [Debate about Berlin housing nationalisation now rising to the Federal level](#)

SEGRO Plc (SGRO.L): Reiterate Buy on stronger demand led by Amazon & Asian retailers - Jonathan also reiterates his Buy rating on Segro given Chinese ecommerce is driving rising UK logistics demand complementing Amazon's existing strength, as well as data centre exposure.

Halma Plc (HLMA.L): CFO & Safety CEO webcast takeaways and Sell-Side Management Lunch Takeaways - Christian Hinderaker notes investors are still focused on Photonics guidance but continues to believe the guide was conservative. **Listen to Christian in our Going Against the Grain podcast [here](#).**

Sector Updates

Europe Consumer Products: Fragrance's next growth wave: back to blockbusters - Aron Adamski and Olivier Nicolai highlight demand is shaped by new offers and blockbusters with Puig and Interparfums having good runways on launches with durable growth. They reiterate their Buy ratings on L'Oreal, Interparfumes and Puig (CMD 28 Oct).

European Pulp & Paper: Shutdowns and the impact for EU pulp players - Gabriel Simoes highlights the announced shut downs are a step in right direction for the weak pulp market, especially softwood, but more is needed. Gabriel prefers downstream to upstream (Buy SW and SIG) and will discuss the broader market at Global Pulp & Paper week on 23-25th June, more [here](#).

Europe: Construction: Heavyside Materials: CO2 costs aren't passing through to European Cement prices (yet) - Ben Rada Martin notes Europe cement has become a profit engine but not because of CO2 pass through, more about market consolidation, supply, demand and CBAM. He sees +LSD pricing increases and still likes Buy-rated Heidelberg and Holcim.

Tracking the data

Europe Retail: Retail Matters: On and Adidas maintain their outperformance in sportswear; in apparel Chinese Aggregator growth turns negative in Europe while Vinted continues to outperform

Europe Branded Consumer Goods: Luxury Goods: Watches round-up May 2026: Swiss Watch Exports +0.4% y/y; latest industry news wrap

Europe Multi-Industry: What US and EU PPI tell us about Multi-Industry - Daniela Costa notes given the Middle East conflict, in May Capital Goods PPI in the US accelerated sequentially and remains well above median levels (+3.0 pp) and European PPI for April shows a sequential acceleration and is above the median (+1.3 pp). **See also:** [Datamap in Pictures: June 2026 \[Presentation\]](#)

Europe Food: EU Nielsen: Broad-based volume improvement at Nestlé and Danone, while Lindt volumes continue to lag the market

Europe Beverages: CCH and Carlsberg outperform subdued soft drinks market in May

Europe Beverages: Europe Nielsen: Soft European beer off-trade in April/May, Heineken outperforms

Europe Tissue: Prices continued to ease in May; Essity outperforms strong incontinence market

Previews

Knorr Bremse (KBX.DE): 2Q26 Barometer and mid-term targets preview; Reiterate Buy - At 2Q results on 30 July, Daniela Costa expects new mid-term targets, positive truck data and increased CVS order intake. She is c7% ahead of consensus on FY29E EBIT.

Adyen NV (ADYEN.AS): 1H26 Preview: 2Q Acceleration Expected on Easier Comps; Modest Margin Refinement; Reiterate Buy - Mo Moawalla expects acceleration at 2Q and continues to forecast growth of 21.5% yoy ex FX as APAC headwinds annualise.

Argenx SE (ARGX.BR): Myositis preview ahead of R&D event and ALKIVIA readout, Buy (on CL) - Rajan Sharma previews the R&D day on 23 June and the upcoming catalysts

including Ph3 ALKIVIA readout (Vyvgart in 3 subtypes). He also increases his revenue estimates by c2% for myositis which looks credible but need to watch efficacy.

Events including M&A

Siemens Energy (ENR1n.DE): Restructuring to bring greater focus & higher margins?; Buy (on CL) - Ajay Patel notes Siemens Energy is considering spinning off Transformation & Industry segment. If the disposal is confirmed would focus portfolio and be +ve margins, on CL and expect cons upgrades with MT guidance at FY.

Barclays Plc (BARC.L): Announces acquisition of GoHenry; Buy

Bankinter (BKT.MC): Announces acquisition of 100% of Tulp Hypotheken; Sell

Birkenstock (BIRK): Further \$500mn share buyback announced; remain Buy

Galderma (GALD.S): Nemluvio Navigator: Prescription trends continue to look encouraging; Buy

Earnings & CMDs

Commodities & Industrials

BMW (BMWG.DE): BMW materially lowers FY26 guidance on China weakness and Europe restructuring; capital return policy unchanged - Christian Frenes notes BMW profit warned overnight, given an acceleration China/APAC deterioration, cost inflation related to Middle East events and one offs from efficiency measures. This is a material downgrade to consensus and Christian lowers his numbers.

Equinor (EQNR.OL): CMD: \$1bn capex step-up to accelerate prod gr. and Buyback upgrade. Remains Sell on negative long-term TTF view, Sell - Michele Della Vigna highlights incremental capex on acceleration of projects on the back of discoveries since '23, fast tracking major developments and a focus on frontier exploration.

Lundin Mining Corp. (LUN.TO): 2026 CMD: Sustaining Operational Consistency to Underpin Growth Execution; Buy

TMT

Auto1 Group (AG1G.DE): CMD First Take: Long-term units growth targets well ahead of consensus with greater disclosure on segment EBITDA; Buy

Informa (INF.L): 5M trading update broadly in line with our expectations; 2026 guidance reiterated; Buy

Healthcare

Elekta AB (EKTA.B.ST): FY27 guidance detail and new mid-term targets imply consensus EBIT upside in FY29; Sell

Straumann AG (STMN.S): Raising FY26 profitability guidance implies +MSD consensus EBIT upgrades; Neutral

BSTL

Securitas AB (SECUB.ST): CMD '26: New strategy and financial targets announced; Sell

Saint-Gobain (SGOB.PA): First Take: Announced divestment of Nordic Distribution business for €1.2bn proceeds

Whitbread (WTB.L): 1Q27: Slightly stronger growth relative to prior current trading commentary; Neutral

Consumer

Tesco (TSCO.L): EBIT growth expectation unchanged despite a slower start to the year (demanding 1Q comparative); PT to 515p, Buy

Douglas AG (DOUn.DE): First Take: 3Q-to-date underperformance leads to updated FY26 adj. EBITDA guidance 7% below consensus; Neutral

Other Macro

Global Economics: Spending Headwinds Still to Come on Both Sides of the Pond - Megan Peters estimates that each 1% pullback in real cash flow from an energy shock results in a 0.6% decline in consumer spending after two quarters.

GOAL: Risk Appetite Reversal - dissecting cross-asset moves in the June roundtrip

Global Rates Trader: Leadership Transitions

Global FX Trader: Dollar in a Collar

Other Global

Americas Utilities: Initiate on PJM IPPs: Structural supply/demand tightness favors Talen; Buy TLN, Neutral on CEG

Americas Chemicals: OLN and HUN announce all-stock merger of equals creating a leading North American chemical company, OlinHuntsman

Tesla Inc. (TSLA): 2Q26 deliveries likely tracking ahead of consensus - raising our estimate

Fujikura (5803.T): Guidance raise: Return to high growth as impacts from hydrogen/fiber sourcing fade; positive on optical products exposure, investment strength; raise TP, Buy

Americas Retail: Specialty Hardlines: Analyzing the impact of Best Buy and Meta's partnership on eyewear retailers

China Industrial Indicators: Partial recovery amid still-weak macro, divergence remains

Americas Technology: Software: Expert Network Series: Dash0 on Observability in the Agentic Age

China Consumer Connection: Online Brand Tracker: May-26: Divergent 618 performance across most sectors; Cosmetics led, IMF/White Goods lag

Navigating China Internet: eCommerce tracker: May industry online retail GMV +3%; 618 trends; Alibaba debates

Disclosure Appendix

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Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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Disclosures

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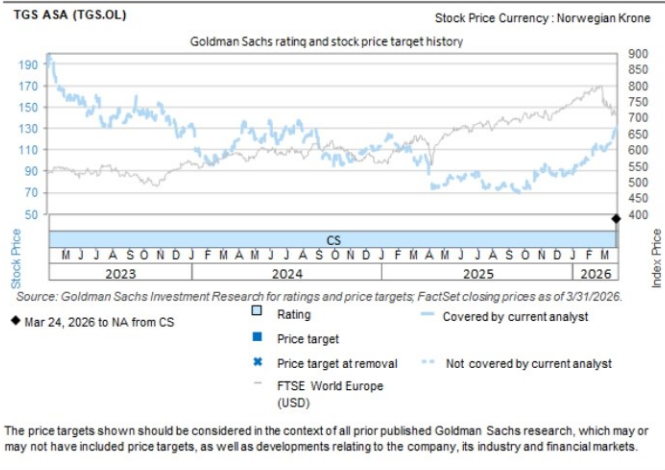
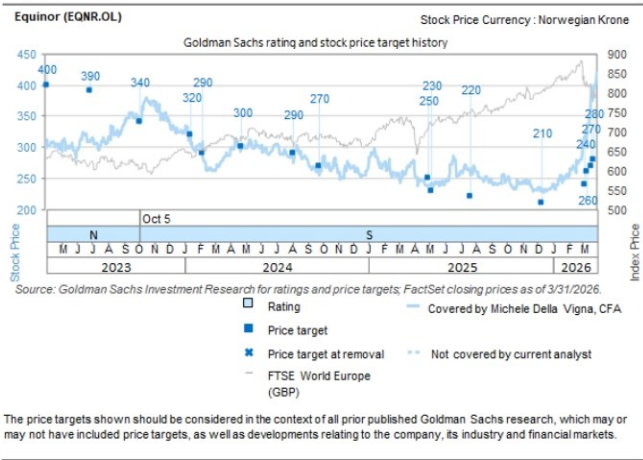
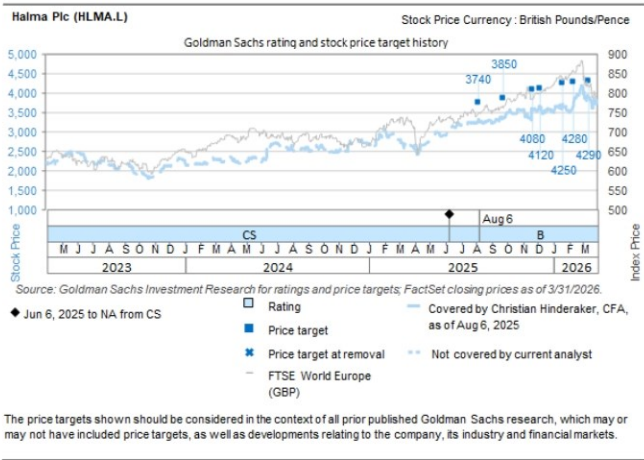
Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	60%	45%

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

TGS ASA (TGS.OL)

Date of report	Target price (Nkr)	Closing price (Nkr)
01-May-26	180.00	150.50
20-Apr-26	170.00	137.80

Halma Plc (HLMA.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
11-Jun-26	5,010	3,928
01-Jun-26	5,060	4,732
13-Mar-26	4,290	3,878
12-Feb-26	4,280	3,742
21-Jan-26	4,250	3,710
08-Dec-25	4,120	3,652
21-Nov-25	4,080	3,540
25-Sep-25	3,850	3,372
06-Aug-25	3,740	3,232

Equinor (EQNR.OL)

Date of report	Target price (Nkr)	Closing price (Nkr)
06-May-26	300.00	349.90
26-Mar-26	280.00	397.50
19-Mar-26	270.00	398.60
12-Mar-26	260.00	332.50
09-Mar-26	240.00	325.40
12-Dec-25	210.00	232.70
23-Jul-25	220.00	256.10
07-May-25	230.00	236.40
30-Apr-25	250.00	237.90
25-Sep-24	270.00	262.50
05-Aug-24	290.00	276.95
25-Apr-24	300.00	305.00
07-Feb-24	290.00	284.60
15-Jan-24	320.00	306.25
05-Oct-23	340.00	341.00
30-Jun-23	390.00	312.10

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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